

Gabriel Pedde Ungureanu | Physics PhD | GPU-Native CFD & HPC Solver Development

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Profile

Physicist (PhD, 6 papers) and mathematician (110/110 *cum laude*) who writes **GPU-native solvers for transport physics**: a **Lattice Boltzmann solver built from scratch in CUDA** and a **distributed compressible flow solver** in MPI + OpenACC, each validated against analytical or reference solutions. First-principles modelling over empirical tuning.

Solver Development — CFD, GPU, Distributed Memory

Lattice Boltzmann CFD Solver

[GitHub](#)

CUDA, written from scratch

2026

- **Architecture:** **D2Q9 BGK solver** for 2D Taylor–Green vortex decay, built from first kernels in CUDA.
- **Optimisation:** restructured distributions **AoS** → **SoA** for coalesced access; added **shared-memory tiling** of the collision step.
- **Performance:** **1174 GFLOP/s** and **809 GB/s** sustained bandwidth; $\sim 123\times$ (collision) / $\sim 66\times$ (streaming) over an optimised CPU baseline on a 2048×2048 lattice.
- **Validation:** matched the analytical kinetic-energy decay rate $\nu = (\tau - 1/2)/3$; also ported to **OpenACC**.

Distributed Compressible Flow Solver

[GitHub](#)

Fortran, MPI + OpenACC/CUDA-Fortran

Dec 2025 – Mar 2026

- **Numerics:** co-authored a **compressible buoyant-flow solver** (thermal plume in a stratified atmosphere): **flux-form finite volume**, Runge–Kutta integration, dimensional splitting, hydrostatic reference state.
- **Parallelism:** **MPI domain decomposition with halo exchange**, plus **OpenMP** and **OpenACC/CUDA-Fortran** offload; run on **Leonardo** (CINECA).
- **Validation:** cross-checked serial vs. MPI vs. hybrid vs. GPU — CPU paths bitwise identical, GPU agreeing to $\sim 10^{-25}$ in L_2 .

Multi-GPU Jacobi & Distributed Linear Algebra

[GitHub](#)

MPI + OpenACC, MPI + cuBLAS

2026

- **Distributed solver:** 2D heat equation on a $40,000\times 40,000$ grid — **MPI domain decomposition + OpenACC** offload, with halo exchange overlapped against GPU compute.
- **Scaling:** strong-scaling study across pure MPI, non-blocking MPI and hybrid MPI+GPU (to 16 ranks), timing communication, host–device transfer and compute separately.
- **Dense linear algebra:** **MPI + cuBLAS** matrix multiplication with a Cannon-style block decomposition.

Numerical PDEs & Solver Validation

[GitHub](#)

PETSc/SLEPc, Python

2026

- **Cross-validation:** stiff **nonlinear parabolic PDE** solved two independent ways — method-of-lines **finite differences** (adaptive RK45) and a **physics-informed neural network** — with its fixed point located by **shooting**: critical exponent $\nu = 0.649$ vs. 0.630 from Monte Carlo. Elliptic/Poisson and nonlinear eigenvalue solvers in **PETSc/SLEPc**.

Research & Engineering Experience

SISSA

Trieste, Italy

Doctoral Researcher — Theoretical Physics & Scientific Computing

2022–2026

- Exact, non-perturbative results in quantum field theory through **large-scale symbolic and numerical computation** on SISSA's Ulysses EuroHPC cluster; **6 published papers**, ~ 60 citations, presented at international conferences and seminars.
- **Verification-first development:** every candidate result is refereed by an independent deterministic evaluator rather than self-graded — the discipline I bring to solver validation.

Education

SISSA / ICTP Joint Programme

Trieste, Italy

Master in High Performance Computing and AI (MHPC)

2025–2026

Concurrent with the final PhD year. **GPU programming** (CUDA, OpenACC), numerical methods for PDEs, parallel computing (MPI/OpenMP), computer architecture, PETSc/SLEPc.

Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore

Brescia, Italy

BSc Mathematics & MSc Physics (Laurea Triennale & Laurea Magistrale)

2017–2022

Real & functional analysis, PDEs, probability; continuum and statistical mechanics. **Best graduate of the year** (MSc Physics); **110/110 cum laude** in both degrees — Italy's maximum grade with honours, equivalent to First-Class Honours / a 4.0 GPA.

Technical Skills

CFD & numerics: **Lattice Boltzmann (D2Q9, BGK)**, finite volume / finite difference, advection–diffusion, compressible & buoyant flow, Runge–Kutta, stiff PDEs, iterative & eigen solvers, validation against analytical solutions

GPU: **CUDA** (kernels, shared memory, constant memory, coalescing, occupancy), **OpenACC**, **cuBLAS**, **Nsight** profiling; GPU memory hierarchy & roofline analysis

Parallel / HPC: **MPI** (domain decomposition, halo exchange, blocking & non-blocking, multi-GPU), **OpenMP**, hybrid MPI+X, **SLURM**, strong/weak scaling; **Leonardo** (CINECA), **Ulysses** (SISSA), **LUMI**

Programming: **C**, **C++**, **CUDA**, **Fortran** (modern, OO); **Python** (NumPy/SciPy), **PETSc/SLEPc**, **HDF5/NetCDF**, **CMake**, **Git**, **Docker**/**Apptainer**, **Linux**

Publications: [INSPIRE-HEP](#) | [Google Scholar](#)

Languages: Italian (native) | English (C1) | Romanian (A2)

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